The Care Support Readiness Checklist

Who will be there, what to write down and what to ask before your husband's care changes.

Your husband's care is about to change, and the plan so far is that everyone will pitch in. This list turns that into things you can map, write down and ask in the days you have. Check what you've done. An unchecked box is something still to do. It says nothing about the plan, or about you.

Map

- [ ] An ordinary day in the new arrangement, laid out in blocks from early morning through overnight.
- [ ] Who has said they'll help, with the days and times each person has actually confirmed. An offer without a day and a time goes down as “not confirmed yet.”
- [ ] The hours with no name in them, overnight included.
- [ ] Who steps in when the person covering a block can't come.
- [ ] The hours the plan leaves to you, and which of them you can keep up. [1]

Write down

- [ ] What you've seen about falls or how he moves around: what happened, where and when.
- [ ] Any difficulty you've noticed with his medications, noted for a professional to review. Leave the medications themselves as they are.
- [ ] Anything about the place he's going that you've seen or been told about, such as the stairs, the bathroom, or the way from the bed to the bathroom at night. [2]
- [ ] The instructions the care team has already given you, in writing, with the date on each. [1]
- [ ] Who to call with a question once the arrangement has changed, with their phone numbers. [1]

Ask

- [ ] Each person who has offered: which days, which hours, and for how long?
- [ ] The care team: every safety question that is still open, written as a question and taken to the professional responsible for it.
- [ ] For each concern and each open hour: who is following up, and by when?

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you map, write down and ask. It doesn't tell you whether the arrangement is safe or whether the help is enough, and a page with every box checked isn't a safety clearance. That judgment belongs to the people who assess your husband.

Ready for the next step?

You've mapped who will be there and written down what is still open. The care interview goes through your husband's situation area by area, so the hours on your map sit beside what he needs during them, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow Medicare's discharge planning checklist. The item marked 2 names places the CDC's home checklist asks families to look at. The rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)
2. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Check for Safety: A Home Fall Prevention Checklist for Older Adults (STEADI brochure, 2018)

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